

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

This month in ALT:

Learn about all the different complications used in watches in Geek-key. Then check out what we've been watching and the gadgets we've been messing around with in DGT.



Humans are the best throwers

The albatross may be really good at flying, the cheetah good at running and the monkey at climbing, but what are humans the best at? Well, its throwing. The fast bowlers in cricket are the pinnacle of human evolution that started when our stonemen ancestors started hunting.

<http://dgit.in/humthr>

WHAT'S NEW

The rule of four

When it comes to time management practices, there are very few rules that emerge that are tried and tested, and according to some experts, one of these is that the human mind can only focus and work for about four hours a day. This might sound shockingly short, but studies of the habits of the creative and ingenious people from history, such as Charles Darwin to Ingmar Bergman have shown that these geniuses only worked for around four hours in a single day. Note that this is not the same as doing brainless tasks, or working like a machine, only for concentrated intellectual effort. In fact, many white collar professionals reach what is increasingly being seen as a biological limit in



which the human brain can be engaged in focused thinking long before the end of the workday, leading to calls for work days to end around 3PM.

Oliver Burkeman, who writes on psychology, success and productivity, writes "the real lesson is that it pays to use whatever freedom you do have over your schedule not to 'maximize your time' or 'optimize your day', in some vague way, but specifically to ring-fence three or four hours of undisturbed focus (ideally when your energy levels are highest)." <http://dgit.in/ruleof4>

Froggo lungs act as noise cancelling headphones

Researchers from the University of Minnesota and St. Olaf College have found a new mechanism in American green treefrogs, that exploit the lung to ear pathway unique to amphibians, to essentially function as noise cancelling earphones. The amphibian ears have evolved in close tandem with the lungs, and allows them to produce loud croaking noises without damaging their own eardrums. The species in question, the

American green treefrog, co-calls with 42 different species in a chorus of mating calls. The



team studied the females of the species, when their lungs were inflated and deflated. When inflated, the frogs responded

only to calls from their own species, whereas when deflated, the frogs interacted with the members of the other species. The researchers found out that the lungs in the inflated state allowed the females of the species to tune in the response of the eardrum, to the frequency most used by the frogs of the same species, and dampen the frequencies used by frogs of other species.

<http://dgit.in/frganc>



Who invented the chicken nugget?

During WWII, the US government commandeered the supply of red meat for the army, leading to a shortage of meat back home. Chicken suddenly got an impetus for production and consumption on an industrial scale. It was in this background that the chicken nugget was born.

<http://dgit.in/chinug>



The American "It" dog

A whole storm of systemic problems have been created by demand from dog breeders for a small, low maintenance dog that is well behaved and camera trained. This has led to inflated prices of the Frenchie, or the French Bulldog, the most hashtagged species on Instagram.

<http://dgit.in/itdog>



GMO Mosquitos

A company wants to release the first batch of genetically modified mosquitoes into the Florida keys, that produce mosquitoes that cannot survive to adulthood, in an effort to reduce dengue and other infectious diseases such as Zika. Locals are however, opposed to the idea.

<http://dgit.in/flogmo>